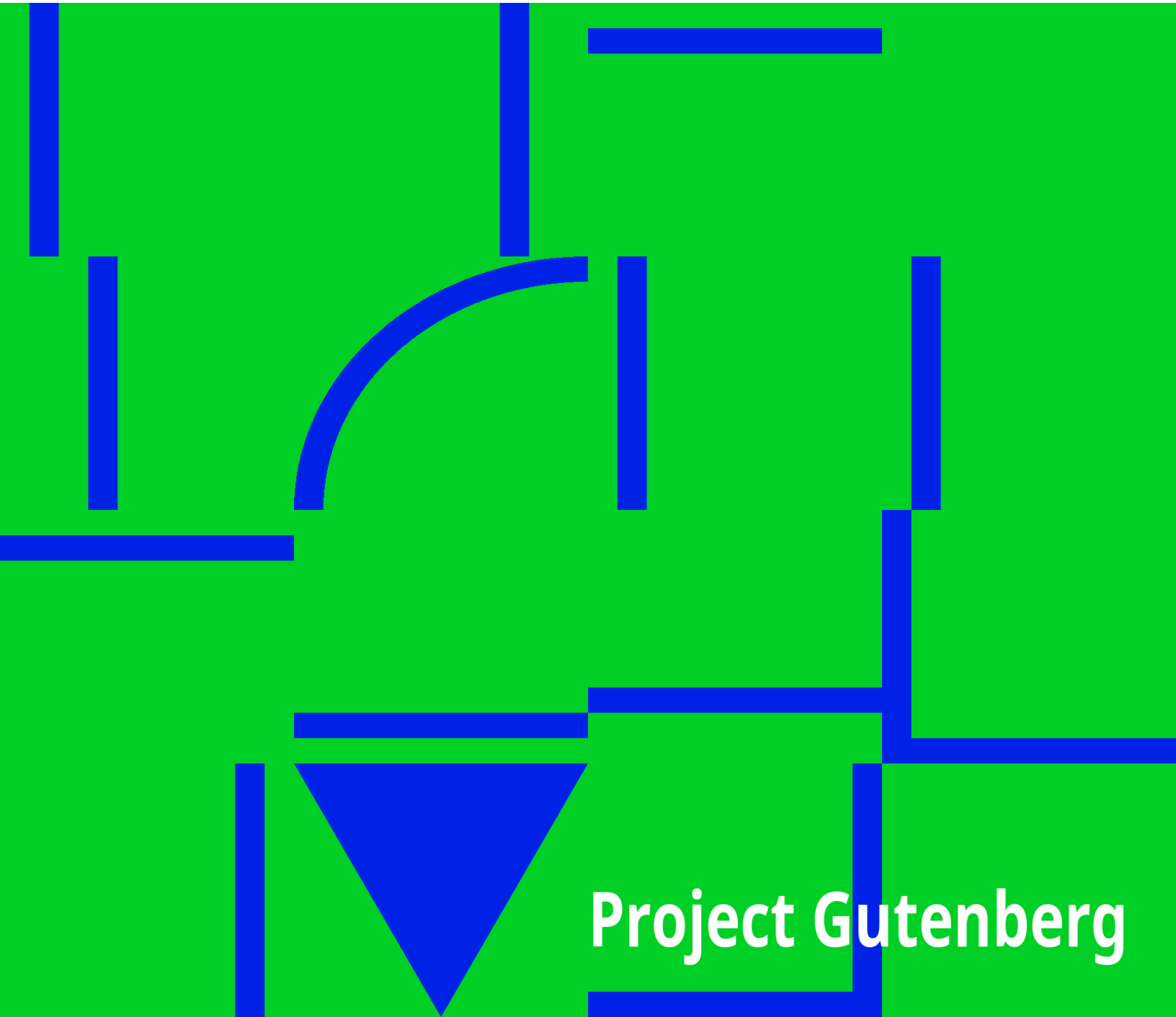


The Butterflies' Ball

Anonymous



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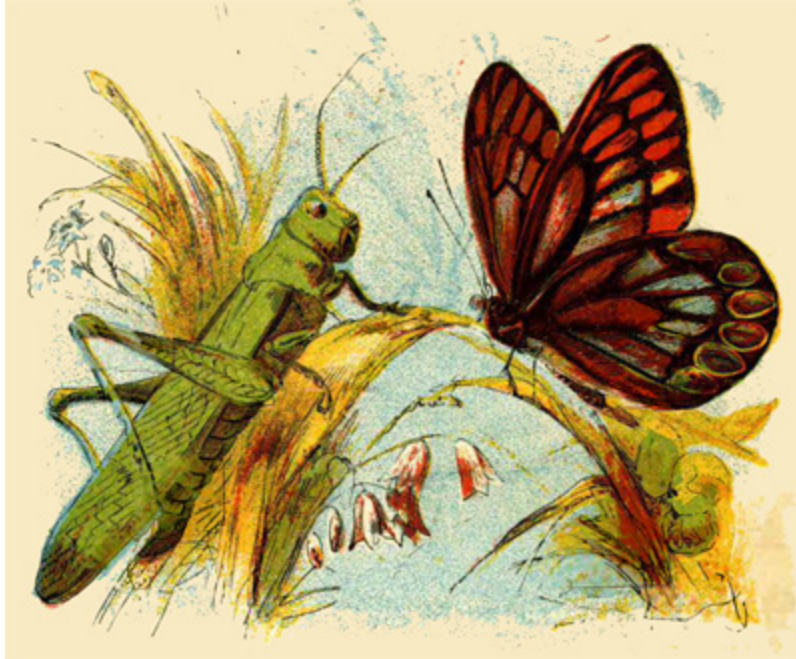
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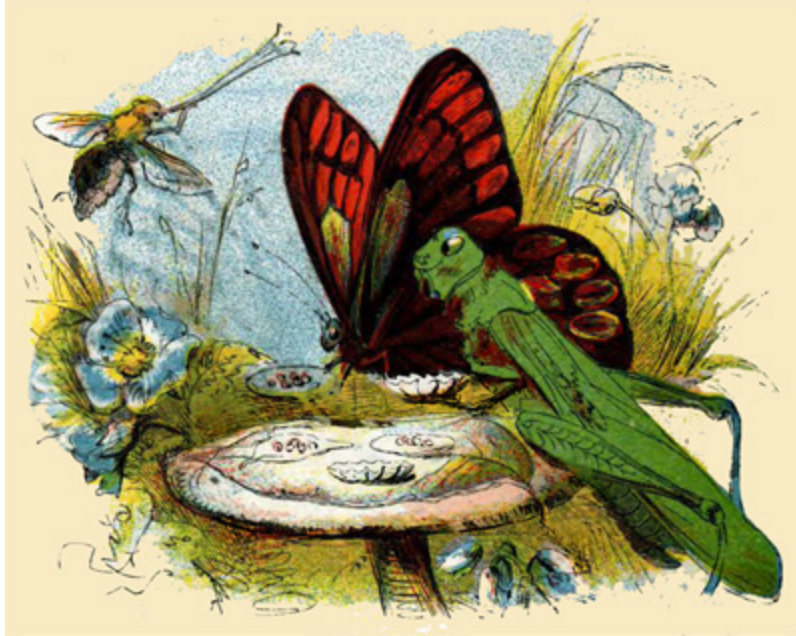
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THE BUTTERFLY'S BALL.



The Butterfly, once, with the
Grasshopper gay,
A grand party gave in the middle of
May;
So, dear little readers, I'll tell you of
all
The guests who were asked to the
feast and the ball.
The Gnat was invited, the Dragonfly,
too,
And all his relations, green, orange,
and blue;
The Wasp, and Cockchafer, the
Beetle and Bee;
The stoutly-made Mole, and the
Emmet so wee;



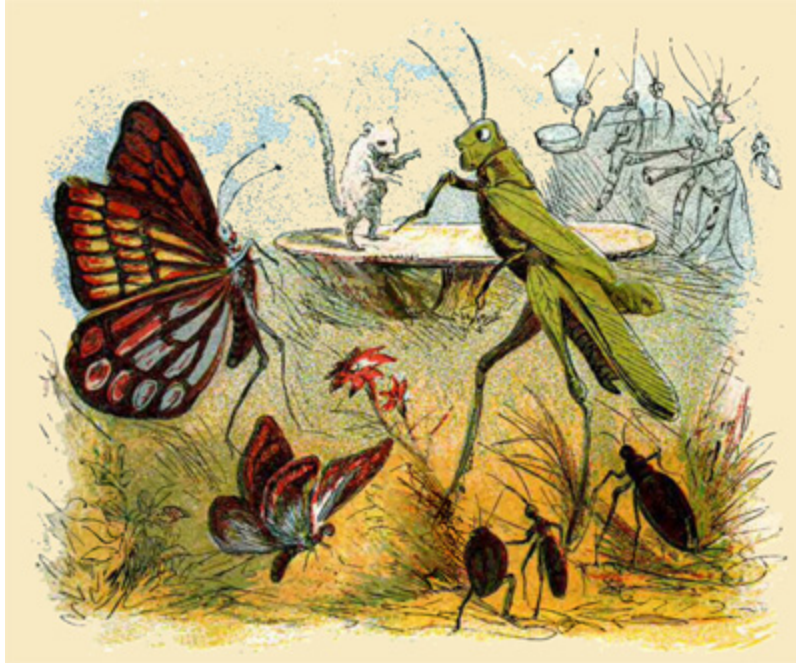
The Dormouse, and Snail, with a host
more, were there
But their names I can't tell you, I
really declare.
The Trumpeter Gadfly (who
summoned the crew)
Bade them all come at six, and to
time, said, be true:
In answer to which, they with
pleasure replied,
That they'd surely be there at the time
specified.
In the very best manner (without the
least doubt)
The kind-hearted hosts the grand
banquet spread out,



Beneath an oak tree, which for ages
had stood,
In beauty and pride in the midst of a
wood.
A mushroom grew there, which a nice
table made,
And a waterdock-leaf for the cloth
was soon laid.
When the moment arrived, ready
waiting were they
To welcome their friends in the
heartiest way;
The first to arrive was the Beetle so
black,
Who carried the Emmet, his friend,
on his back;



The Gnat and the Dragonfly next did
each bring
His friends; then the Wasp came,
without his sharp sting.
The Cockchafer hummed, as he
journeyed along,
Some songs he intended to sing to the
throng.
The sly little Dormouse peeped out of
his hole,
And led to the feast his blind cousin,
the Mole.
In fact they all came, as they
promised to do,
In the picture before you, so plain to
the view.



The viands were various; delighted
were they;
Some honey the Bee brought, to
honor the day.
Said he, "My dear friends, I am far
behind time,
But, WORK BEFORE PLAY, is a
maxim of mine."
The feast now commenced, they ate
and they talked
Of the news of the day, and the
distance they'd walked
When the banquet was finished, they
said one and all,
That Gaffer Grasshopper must open
the ball;



Behold him then, bowing politely,
advance
To ask Madam Butterfly with him to
dance.
The dancing began, each a partner
had got,
Excepting the Snail, who said, dance
she could not,
For, fatigued with the distance the
length of an ell,
She said she must sleep in her own
little shell.
The party was merry,—and well it
might be—
For the Cockchafer sang, and a soft
voice had he:



The name of the song I've forgotten
completely,
And also the words, but they sounded
most sweetly.
The company, charmed, entreated
another,
And he favored them, gladly, with
"Jack and his brother;"
When ended the song, (it was loudly
applauded,)
The dance, for a time, again pleasure
afforded,
'Till slily came on the dark shadows
of night,
And the Watchmen, the Glowworms,
each showed his bright light;



By the aid of their lanterns, each
safely reached home;
For some from a very great distance
had come.
Recollect, little readers, the saying is
true,
And I think, when you read it, you'll
all say so too:
That "EARLY TO BED AND EARLY TO RISE
MAKE ALL BECOME HEALTHY, WEALTHY
AND WISE."

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